

Tuscan White Bean and Kale Soup (Variation 15)

Tags: soup, vegan, italian, healthy, gluten-free | Prep: 15 min | Cook: 35 min | Serves: 12

Ingredients

- 6 tbsp olive oil
- 2 large onion, diced
- 8 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 celery stalks, sliced
- 4 medium carrots, diced
- 2 tsp dried marjoram
- 2 tsp dried thyme
- 2/2 tsp chilli flakes
- 4 cans (400 g each) cannellini beans, drained
- 2 can (400 g) crushed tomatoes
- 3 litres vegetable stock
- 400 g kale, stems removed and roughly chopped
- Juice of 2 lemon
- Salt and black pepper
- Extra virgin olive oil and crusty bread to serve

Method

1. Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add onion, celery, and carrots; cook for 8 minutes until softened.
2. Add garlic, rosemary, thyme, and chilli flakes. Cook for 1 minute.
3. Add beans, crushed tomatoes, and stock. Bring to a boil.
4. Mash about a quarter of the beans against the side of the pot to create a creamy base.
5. Reduce heat and simmer for 15 minutes.
6. Stir in kale and simmer for a further 5–8 minutes until wilted and tender.
7. Add lemon juice. Taste and season generously with salt and pepper.
8. Serve with a drizzle of extra virgin olive oil and crusty bread.

Chef Tips

- Mashing some beans is the key step — it creates the characteristic creamy body without any dairy.
- This soup thickens significantly on standing; add a splash of stock when reheating.
- A Parmesan rind added to the simmering soup (remove before serving) adds tremendous depth.